Your first 10 minutes of Hebrew

Goal: Read 3 real Hebrew words aloud after 5 letters and 2 vowels, within a 10-minute budget.

Hebrew is written and read from **right to left**. On every practice row the black model is at the **right**; trace it, then keep writing to the left as the letters fade from grey, to dotted, to empty.

The plan (10 minutes)

1 min	**Hebrew reads right to left.** Start at the right edge. You will learn 5 letters and 2 vowel signs, then read 3 real words.
2 min	**Five letters.** shin, lamed, vav, mem, he
1.5 min	**Two vowel signs.** kamatz, holam-male
1.5 min	**Read your first word.** word: shalom
1 min	**Read a second word.** word: sham
1 min	**Read a third word.** word: mah
1.5 min	**Which one says shalom?.** shalom / sham / mah
0.5 min	**You read 3 Hebrew words.** Self-reported. Nothing here has been tested with learners yet.

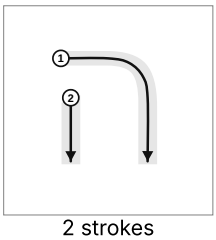
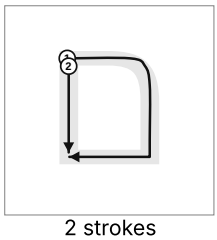
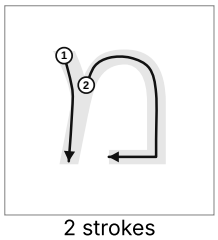
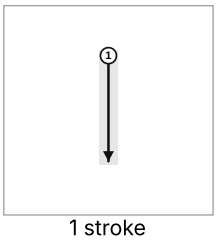
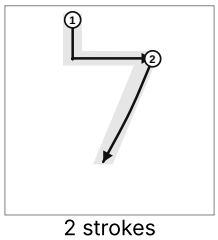
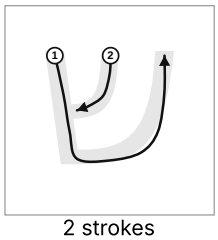
The 6 letter shapes you need

ה He: h	ם Mem sofit (at the end of a word): m	מ Mem: m	ו Vav: v	ל Lamed: l	ש Shin: sh

DRAFT, unreviewed by any Hebrew teacher. Pronunciation shown is Israeli only. Not user-tested; the 10-minute figure is a design budget, not a measured result. Only one of the three words (shalom) is in the Priestly Blessing. The blessing's other words need letters (yod, bet, resh, kaf, final kaf, nun, and so on) and vowels (tzere, segol, shva) outside the 5 letters and 2 vowels taught here. Extending to the full verse is a later step.

Pages: letters in print (page 2) and in cursive handwriting (page 3), the two vowel signs and three words (page 4), then the 20-step ladder from fully pointed words to unpointed words (pages 5 and 6).

Printed letters, as in books and prayer books. Numbered circle = where a stroke starts, arrowhead = where it ends.
Draft stroke order, not teacher-reviewed.

ה	ם	מ	ו	ל	ש
He	**Mem sofit**	**Mem**	**Vav**	**Lamed**	**Shin**
					
2 strokes	2 strokes	2 strokes	1 stroke	2 strokes	2 strokes

☐ **1** Shin sh /ʃ/



☐ **2** Lamed l /l/



☐ **3** Vav v (or part of the vowel o/u) /v/



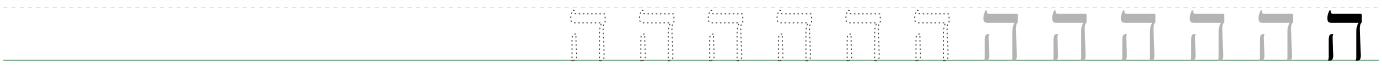
☐ **4** Mem m /m/



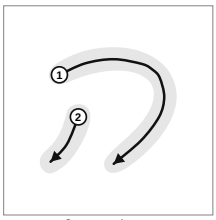
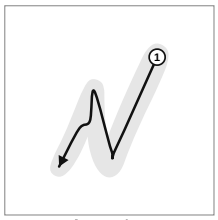
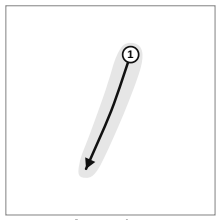
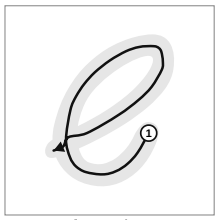
☐ **4b** Mem sofit (at the end of a word) m /m/



☐ **5** He h at the start, silent at the end of a word /h/



Israeli handwriting (ktav yad), as people write by hand. Shapes come from the font Gveret Levin; real handwriting varies. Numbered circle = where a stroke starts, arrowhead = where it ends. **Draft stroke order, not teacher-reviewed.**

He	Mem sofit	Mem	Vav	Lamed	Shin
					
2 strokes	1 stroke	1 stroke	1 stroke	1 stroke	1 stroke

☐ **1** Shin sh /ʃ/

☐ **2** Lamed l /l/

☐ **3** Vav v (or part of the vowel o/u) /v/

☐ **4** Mem m /m/

☐ **4b** Mem sofit (at the end of a word) m /m/

☐ **5** He h at the start, silent at the end of a word /h/

A vowel sign sits under (or, for the vav-with-dot, next to) the letter. Trace the pairs, then the words. Models use the print font so the marks are clear.

☐ **ah** · kamatz Kamatz: the T-shaped sign under the letter.

מָ שָׁ לָ הָ מָ שָׁ לָ הָ מָ שָׁ לָ הָ

☐ **oh** · holam-male Vav with a dot above it reads as the vowel oh; the vav is not a v here.

לוֹ שׁוֹ מוֹ לוֹ שׁוֹ מוֹ לוֹ שׁוֹ מוֹ

Read and write three words

שָׁלוֹם

1. shah-LOHM = peace

Letters, right to left: Shin, Lamed, Vav, Mem. Priestly Blessing, Numbers 6:26 (last word); also Oseh Shalom.
Without the vowel signs it is written שלום.

שָׁלוֹם שָׁלוֹם שָׁלוֹם

שָׁם

2. shahm = there

Letters, right to left: Shin, Mem. Common word, not from the Priestly Blessing.
Without the vowel signs it is written שם.

שָׁם שָׁם שָׁם

מָה

3. mah = what

Letters, right to left: Mem, He. Common word, not from the Priestly Blessing.
Without the vowel signs it is written מה.

מָה מָה מָה

Read each word aloud, then tick it. Stage 1 words use only the letters above; from step 4 on, other letters and signs appear (follow the gloss and the key). Target (unmeasured): 80% on the 20 unpointed words after the ladder.

Stage 1: Fully pointed (steps 1-6)

☐	**1**	שָׁלוֹם	peace
☐	**2**	שָׁם	there
☐	**3**	מָה	what
☐	**4**	לֹא	no, not
☐	**5**	טוֹב	good
☐	**6**	יוֹם	day

Stage 2: First letter pointed (steps 7-12)

☐	**7**	אָב	father
☐	**8**	כֹּל	all
☐	**9**	גַּם	also
☐	**10**	כֵּן	yes
☐	**11**	אֵין	there is not
☐	**12**	יֵשׁ	there is

Now the vowel signs are gone, as in a newspaper or a street sign. Try each word from its letters and meaning; peek at the key only for stage 3 words.

Stage 3: Unpointed, with a hint (steps 13-18). Stuck? Look at the key below; a word read after the hint does not count as read unpointed

☐ **13** מים water

☐ **14** בית house

☐ **15** ספר book

☐ **16** תודה thanks

☐ **17** שנה year

☐ **18** עוד more, still

Stage 4: Unpointed, no hint (steps 19-20)

☐ **19** אבל but

☐ **20** אמא mom

Key: all 20 words with their vowel signs

1 שָׁלוֹם peace	**2** שָׁם there	**3** מָה what	**4** לֹא no, not
5 טוֹב good	**6** יוֹם day	**7** אָב father	**8** כֹּל all
9 גַּם also	**10** כֵּן yes	**11** אֵין there is not	**12** יֵשׁ there is
13 מַיִם water	**14** בַּיִת house	**15** סֵפֶר book	**16** תּוֹדָה thanks
17 שָׁנָה year	**18** עוֹד more, still	**19** אֲבָל but	**20** אִמָּא mom

DRAFT, unreviewed. Glosses and points written by the module author; not checked by a Hebrew teacher. Later steps use letters and vowels beyond the first-10-minutes set. Not tested on learners.